

Unit Y316: Britain and Ireland 1791–1921

This theme focuses on the relationship between mainland Britain and Ireland during the period 1791–1921. Learners should consider how far, and for what reasons, this relationship changed. The strands identified below are not to be studied in isolation to each other. They are not self-contained and learners need to examine the inter-relationship of religious, political, social, economic and cultural factors.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: Britain and Ireland 1791–1921	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
Opposition to the Union	Revolutionary nationalism including Wolfe Tone and the United Irishmen, Young Ireland, the Fenians, the Land League, Sinn Féin, the Easter Rising 1916, the Anglo-Irish War 1919–1921; constitutional nationalism including O’Connell, Parnell and Redmond, Catholic Emancipation and the Home Rule movement; cultural nationalism 1798–1921 including the Enlightenment, Young Ireland and the Gaelic Revival; the role of the Roman Catholic Church in opposition.
Support for the Union	Protestant Ascendancy and its decline from the 1870s; Unionism and the rise of Ulster Unionism 1886–1921 and its strategies; the policies and approaches of the Conservative, Whig and Liberal parties and their leaders; the role of the Anglican and Presbyterian Churches in support for the Union.
The Union and reform	The creation of the Act of Union; reform within the Union from 1829 including Catholic Emancipation 1829, reforms in administration, education, land and local government; Home Rule and Partition.
The Irish economy and the link to Irish Nationalism	Agrarian under-development and population pressures, land and economic issues in their own right and in relation to nationalism, the impact of the Famine 1845–1849; industrialisation and Ulster; North/South and regional differences.

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Depth Studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
Irish Rebellions and British Responses 1791–1803	Irish politics at the end of the 18 th century; impact of the French Revolution and the wars on Ireland (Catholic Committee, United Irishmen, Orange Order, Bantry Bay) and the British response (Fitzwilliam, Lake and Castlereagh); the causes, leadership, extent, support and consequences of the 1798 Wolfe Tone Rising; Grattan's Parliament; Pitt and the creation of the Act of Union 1800; the causes, nature and consequences of Emmet's Rising 1803; the impact of the rebellions on Revolutionary Nationalism.
O'Connell and British Governments 1823–1841	The strategies of the Roman Catholic Association and government response; O'Connell's leadership to 1829; the Waterford and Clare elections and the Brunswick Clubs; the reasons for and the impact of Roman Catholic Emancipation to 1841 including O'Connell and the Whigs, the Tithe War and the Irish Church to 1838, the Lichfield House compact and reform to 1841.
The Crisis over Home Rule 1908–1914	Redmond, Home Rule and the Liberal Government of Asquith 1908 to 1914; the Home Rule Bill of 1912 and subsequent negotiations over exclusion; the reasons for and tactics of the Ulster Unionists (Carson, Craig and the Conservatives of Bonar Law, Solemn League and Covenant, the militarisation of Ulster – the Ulster Volunteers), the response of the various nationalists (the Irish Volunteers) and the government (Curragh Mutiny); the situation in 1914, enactment and suspension of Home Rule, the response of Redmond to this and the declaration of the First World War.